

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, June 14, 2017, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Lovett at 6:31 p.m.

Members of the Council present were:

Ward I Councilor Carolyn Towle
Ward II Councilor Scott Pope
At-Large Councilor Keith Raymond
Assistant Mayor Victor Bergeron
Mayor Charlene Lovett
At-Large Councilor Allen Damren
At-Large Councilor Bruce Temple
Ward III Councilor Nicholas Koloski
At-Large Councilor John Simonds

Also present were:

Ryan McNutt, City Manager
Jane Taylor, City Solicitor
Mary Walter, Finance Director

AGENDA CHANGES

Mayor Lovett moved BUDGET to after CITIZEN’S FORUM and moved 13A., Resolution 2017-45 Rice Reservoir Spillway – Public Hearing to the first item under 11. NEW BUSINESS.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Ms. Towle to accept the minutes of the May 10, 2017, City Council meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0 with 1 abstain, Mayor Lovett, as she was not at the meeting.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. Simonds to accept the minutes of the May 11, 2017, City Council meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0 with 1 abstain, Mayor Lovett, as she was not at the meeting.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. Damren to accept the minutes of the May 18, 2017, City Council meeting, as amended.

Mayor Lovett said on page 3, toward the end of the Fire Department discussion that she recalls Fire Chief Rick Bergeron responding to her question about the gasoline/diesel line item that those could be lowered.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. Raymond to accept the minutes of the May 24, 2017, City Council meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Ms. Towle to accept the minutes of the May 31, 2017, City Council meeting.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

MAYOR'S NOTES

Mayor Lovett read her notes:

- Thanked the Claremont Elks Lodge, American Legion and Rolling Thunder for holding a Flag Day Ceremony tonight
- Thanked the Stevens Alumni Association for a great parade and scholarships
- There will be a joint meeting of the Council and School Board on June 22nd
- City Manager performance review on June 28th
- Thanked the public for its participation, the City Administration, Council and Council Clerk for the work on the budget.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Mr. McNutt said he will send information to the Council about de-leading the water system.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Frances J. Tolles Home Trustees

A motion was made by Mr. Pope and seconded by Mr. Koloski to re-appoint Cherie Leavitt to seat #6 of the Frances J. Tolles Home Trustees.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Arthur Vitro, Ward 1, said he objected to a misstatement of facts on May 11th that there was a list of Claremont jobs available for viewing in City Hall. He said no list exists. In the current issue of the e-Ticker News, "My Turn" column, City Manager McNutt wrote that the Library, Library

Trustees and Friends of the Library have not been as proactive as they could be about securing grants and other fundraising activities. He has been the treasurer for the Trustees of the Library for a number of years. On August 28, 2015, he wrote a check to Konica Minolta for \$5,974.70 as payment toward a new microfilm reader, \$3,100 shy of the full purchase price which was \$9,074. The additional \$3,100 was supplied from the Friends of the Library and a donation from a community sponsor. April 2016 he signed a check to AWE Digital Learning Solutions for \$5,456 for two children's' learning computers. That money was available because a week earlier he had deposited a \$5,000 check from a private foundation that Library Board of Trustees had sought. That is more than \$14,500 new equipment for the Library in the last two years. The statement from the City Manager has left him disheartened and soured on the volunteer experience.

BUDGET

Mayor Lovett gave her financial overview. FY 17 budget used \$1.465 million from fund balance. FY 18 budget relies on approximately \$900,000 from fund balance. Neither budget had money for road maintenance. Bonding was done for road improvements. The City is projected to have a \$1.7 million fund balance, which is the minimum amount recommended by DRA. The City's tax burden may be average, but residents' ability to pay is less. Economic growth will increase the City's valuation. The cuts proposed by the City Manager will be difficult and FY 19 will be another difficult year.

Resolution 2018-1 Tax Anticipation Note – Public Hearing

Pursuant to the Municipal Finance Act, the City Treasurer, with the approval of the City Manager, is hereby authorized to issue and sell notes of the City of Claremont, in an amount not to exceed \$1,000,000.00 in anticipation of receipt of taxes for the fiscal year 2018.

Such amount will not exceed the total tax levy for the year 2017.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Raymond to adopt Resolution 2018-1 Tax Anticipation Note.

Ms. Walter said the City typically does not use the TAN (Tax Anticipation Note). This is just in case we need to use it.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Roll call vote: motion carried 9-0.

Resolution 2018-2 To Adopt the 2018 General Fund Budget for the City of Claremont –
Public Hearing

In accordance with the Charter of the City of Claremont, and the Statutes of the State of New Hampshire, the City Council is required to establish a budget for its appropriations and revenues for its municipal activities for all departments for the 2018 fiscal year as published.

A motion was made by Mr. Temple and seconded by Mr. Damren to adopt Resolution 2018-2 To Adopt the 2018 General Fund Budget for the City of Claremont.

Mr. McNutt said he was asked to present three scenarios to build back an additional \$149,000. He said these are not his personal recommendations. These are the ways he was able to achieve what was asked of him. He showed a PowerPoint presentation.

- Previously Stated Council Priorities
 - Economic Development is a priority
 - Growing the tax base is a priority
 - Paving roads is a priority
 - Lowering the total tax is a priority
- The Three Choices to Find Additional \$149,000
 - #1 no tax impact = sustain current tax rate of \$14.86
 - Eliminate \$30,000 from Property Clean-up (NICE)
 - Cut Legal by additional \$25,000
 - Delay Fire Chief replacement (after current Chief retires) by 6 months \$12,000
 - Eliminate Business Development position \$77,000
 - Believes he and Planning and Development Director Nancy Merrill can do this, but it would take away his time to do other beneficial things and would be an additional burden on Ms. Merrill
 - Cut additional \$5,000 by nipping and tucking throughout
 - This would restore 1 position in the Library, fund the Bus Service at \$25,000 and \$3,000 for Animal Control. Leave tax rate at \$14.86.
 - #2 Add everything to the tax rate
 - Tax rate will be \$15.07 per \$1,000
 - #3 Retain Animal Control \$3,000, retain the funds for the Library \$79,000 and fund the Bus Service \$25,000 within the scope of the budget as originally proposed at a 6 cent increase for a tax rate of \$14.92
 - Eliminate \$30,000 from Property Clean-up (NICE)
 - Cut Legal by additional \$25,000
 - Delay Fire Chief replacement (after current Chief retires) by 6 months \$12,000
 - Eliminate Business Development position \$77,000
 - The largest impact to him would be the ability to address blighted properties.
 - This would jeopardize the ability to fund the Business Development Coordinator position going forward

- The choices he was asked to present to Council are NOT his recommendations, but only scenarios to reach Council's requests
 - By not filling the Business Development position and keeping the Library position, next year's budget will be that much more difficult
- Choices Have Impacts on Next Year's Budget
 - Next year – Police contract = add \$168,810
 - Next year – Paving \$\$ in the base = \$250,000
 - Both will add about 75 cents onto the tax rate
 - There are other variables such as disposition of abatement requests that are unknown at this time
 - If that is not a sustainable increase, then you need to look at cuts NOW
- Making Sustainable Choices
 - Health insurance costs the City \$2.2 million per year. A 10% increase (keep in mind it's been 17% and 23% the last 2 years) adds \$222,000.
 - Retirement payments into NHRS cost the City \$1.25 million per year. A 4% increase adds another \$50,000
 - If no other cost items in the budget increase within the City (which is highly unlikely since Directors took a 5% decrease in their budgets this year), there is the potential to add \$1.50 to the City's portion of the tax rate next year
- All Choices Have Impacts
 - Departments took a 5% reduction overall in their budgets. Most of that is not sustainable
 - Less money will drop into fund balance
 - Minimum fund balance is \$1.7 million, but actually should be \$3 million
 - CIP projects have not been funded as needed over the past few years
 - Vehicle & equipment have not been replaced the last 2 budgets meaning higher maintenance and repair costs
 - Interest rates are now starting to climb meaning it's going to cost us more to borrow money for some of the bigger projects
 - Increases to health and retirement are going to continue to rise

At 7:18 p.m., Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing.

Regarding the 5-minute time limit, George Caccavaro, read from RSA 32:5 saying that a public hearing is not the same as a public meeting and the 5-minute limit could be in violation.

Ms. Taylor said it is up to the Council to make its own rules and can set a time limit at its pleasure as long as it is applied equally.

There was consensus of the Council to stay with the 5-minute rule.

Barry McMann, Ward 3, uses the Library and he is concerned about the cuts. The streets have potholes and sidewalks need repairs. He would hate to see the Library close.

Mark Barriger, Ward 1, said if there are cuts to the Fire Department, the City would rely more on mutual aid. There is also the possibility that the county, school and state taxes could go up.

George Caccavaro, Ward 2, said the majority of the taxes are not coming from City Hall, but from the Dow building (School). Cutting the Library is an exercise in futility. The Department of Labor will not allow volunteers to replace paid employees. He said according to the NH Library Association President, the average Library cost per person is \$45.08; the Fiske Free Library is below that average.

Jim Chamberlain, Ward 3, President of the Professional Firefighters of Claremont said he had serious reservations about the possibility of laying off firefighters. He stressed the dangers that presents them. He referenced the Cherry Hill Road fire where two firefighters were seriously injured.

Gwen Melcher, Ward 3, City Clerk/Tax Collector, talked about the proposal to add the Library money back into the budget and cutting other departments. Other departments were cut due to layoffs in 2001 and again in 2011. In Central Collections in 1997, there were five people and now there are three. There are many other departments doing more with less.

Sharon Wood, Ward 3, worked for 25 years at the Library and was a Technical Services Librarian when she retired. She has lived in Claremont for 45 years. All the departments work together to make this a great city. She took Ms. Melcher's comments seriously. She said the Library is an active/busy place. Cutting staff hours from 160 full-time hours to 80 and doing all the work of 160 full-time hours is not doable. Shutting the Library for 6 additional hours per week does not balance cutting 80 manhours.

Tom Belaire, Ward 2, said he was not clear on the Fire Department budget. The SAFER (Staffing for Adequate Fire & Emergency Response) grant money will run out in March. He asked if those positions will be laid off or if there will be funding to get through to the end of the year.

At 7:35 p.m. Mayor Lovett closed the public hearing.

Mr. McNutt said as it presently sits, there is no plan to retain the SAFER firefighters when funding runs out in March.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren to amend the FY 2018 proposed budget as follows:

- **Policy decrease \$5,000 for a total of \$506,031**
- **City Administration decrease \$2,000 for a total of \$980,655**
- **General Services decrease \$17,400 for a total of \$916,994**
- **Fire decrease \$4,000 for a total of \$2,549,805**
- **Streets & Roads decrease \$445,000 for a total of \$2,305,577**
- **Parks decrease \$8,000 for a total of \$292,711**
- **CSB-Recreation decrease \$36,000 for a total of \$1,152,087**
- **Library add \$35,000 for a total of \$376,987**

Ms. Walter asked if there was anything for the bus. Mr. Damren said the City Manager originally agreed to find the \$25,000 for the bus. Ms. Walter said the City Manager's proposed budget does not have that. Mr. Damren said he will add to his motion.

Mr. Damren said the new total would be \$15,906,669. The Revenue Summary will need to be adjusted. The number from fund balance needs to be cut by \$445,000 for a total of \$673,855 and a Revenue total of \$5,491,815.

Mr. Damren said this doesn't address the Fire Department question.

Mr. Temple seconded the motion for discussion.

Mr. Damren said the purpose of this is to get the estimated tax increase as low to zero as possible and to try to get as much money into the Library as possible, but he wasn't as successful as he would have liked. The increase is about a penny. Looking through the departments, he felt he couldn't go any deeper.

Mr. Damren said the \$445,000 from Streets and Roads is for the two culverts. When the bids come in, Public Works can come back to Council to request to take the money from fund balance.

Mr. Temple expressed his concern for multiple things including the Whitewater and East Street culverts not being in the budget, no pay increases for Public Works, insurance increases, and the City's share of the North & Main Streets Project may go up. He is concerned with the 18/19 budget. If there is an increase of \$2 million assessed value to get \$300,000 tax revenue and then there is an increase in health insurance, that gain will be gone. Fire previously had four people on each shift and then with the SAFER grants, they were able to bring on people. Beyond March, there is nothing in the budget for the SAFER grant employees. In March, the Fire Department will ask for new firefighters. There will be a structural deficit and you can't go back to the "rainy day" fund (fund balance). He said the Whitewater and East Street culverts need to be done. He is concerned about taking the money out of fund balance. Building fund balance is difficult to do.

Mr. Bergeron said he cannot support the motion. When he makes his vote, it will be in the best interest of the City, not individual departments.

Mr. Pope asked what the cost is to keep two SAFER Grant firefighter positions. Ms. Walter said each firefighter costs about \$70,000 a year depending upon health insurance (single, family, etc.).

Ms. Walter asked where the \$17,400 cut in General Services would come from. Mr. Damren said no particular place; he would leave that decision to department heads.

Mr. Raymond said he has been here since 2001. The City had the highest tax rate in the state then and the City has the highest tax rate now. Maybe it's time to put money back in. There is a need to fill vacancies. He sees the lines of people in Central Collections. He is not in favor of cutting firefighters or the Library. He will vote no to these cuts. He was in favor of Mr. McNutt's original proposal and the 6 cent increase that went with it.

Mr. Koloski said he can't vote on this because the department heads are not here to explain what they will do with the cuts and the ramifications. He can't support the motion. As far as the City putting the money in for the bus, he was under the impression the City would find the money in the budget as presented, but with this motion, he doesn't think that is possible.

Mr. Simonds said he cannot support the motion. The budget lines are bare bones.

Mr. Raymond said the tax rate increase most of the time is due to insurance increases and/or cost shifting from the state and are beyond the City's control.

Mayor Lovett said more cuts will be made next year.

Mr. Pope asked, in the last five years, how much has the state cut. Ms. Walter said almost \$1 million a year. Mr. Pope said, to put it in perspective, the City has been picking up almost \$1 million each year.

Ms. Towle said she takes calls from people struggling to pay their taxes and to stay in their homes. She will not support Mr. Damren's motion.

A motion was made by Mr. Simonds and seconded by Mr. Temple to move the question.

Roll call vote to move the question: motion carried 9-0.

Roll call vote on the motion failed 1-8 with all Councilors except Mr. Damren voting no.

Mr. McNutt said regarding the \$445,000 for Streets & Roads, this is an appropriate use of fund balance, one time use. These culverts are in serious need of repair. The initial estimates were \$220,000 each. He said Public Works Director Scott Sweet believes that he might be able to do one culvert cheaper. However, once he gets into the job, there may be a change order. It is burdensome for Mr. Sweet to come to Council for the money and then if there is a change order, to come back to Council. Mr. McNutt said if the funds are not used from fund balance, then the money will stay in fund balance.

Mr. Sweet said the East Street culvert will come in close to \$220,000. The Whitewater culvert will probably come in around \$50,000-\$75,000. There are other culverts such as Bible Hill and Girard Avenue in poor condition that he could spend the money on.

Mr. Sweet said he has an engineer working on the Bible Hill and Girard Avenue culverts. Mr. Damren encouraged him to bring the funding request for those culverts back to Council and Council could move the money then.

Mr. Pope said he supports the City Manager on this. If you use less, then that is less that is taken out of fund balance.

Mr. Temple was concerned about being able to sustain ourselves after taking \$445,000 out of fund balance without a CIP. He's concerned about settling the other union contracts. He's concerned about next year's health insurance increases. He said either bite the bullet and let taxes go up or tweak things so people can pay their taxes

Mr. Pope suggested reducing the number to two culverts and then Mr. Sweet could come back to ask for more money if he wanted to do additional culverts.

Mr. McNutt said regarding fund balance, that it is typically for one-time expenses. The City has been using portions of fund balance for operating expenses such as the \$320,000 to cover debt service on the Downtown TIFD. He believes the City's economic development team can increase values in the City, but no promises. To achieve what the City wants is approximately \$20 million in net new tax base. That would cover the TIFD. There are variables. The goal is to reduce drawing down from fund balance for operating expenses. The economic development team will continue toward economic growth and to start putting positive money in fund balance, but it will take time to get there.

There was a discussion about retaining the SAFER firefighters through the end of June. Ms. Walter said when the SAFER and COPS grants were before the Council, it was made clear that the City didn't have to maintain those positions once the grants were spent.

Mr. Koloski said he is a firefighter and was at the Cherry Hill event. He was injured in that fire. There were three people working that shift. He doesn't want to get back to the days of three-man shifts. It is difficult to staff with volunteers.

It was the consensus of the Council that nothing could be done without having a discussion with the Fire Chief.

Mr. Damren said, regarding Mr. McNutt's options, that he will not support them because there is no funding/elimination of the Business Development Coordinator. Mayor Lovett said that position was not filled in 2017. Mr. McNutt said it is funded in this budget. His recommendation is to leave it in the budget; he would probably not fill it and the money would drop into fund balance at the end of the year. His recommendation to use this money for the Library would not impact another person. Economic development would stay status quo.

Council discussed Mr. McNutt's Option #1.

Mayor Lovett said operations in the Planning and Development office will remain status quo and there will be money for the Library.

Mr. Damren will vote no. The Planning and Development position is needed. This is the first time in a lot of years that the City will be using outside legal counsel instead of in-house counsel, so it is way too soon to take from that area.

Mr. Pope agreed with Mr. Damren. Property cleanup benefits the City. Losing legal scares him.

Mr. Bergeron is not in favor of taking the property cleanup money. Eventually the City will end up having to pay to cleanup abandoned, unsafe properties.

Mr. Koloski is in favor of removing the \$30,000 from the property cleanup as that is built into the contract when properties are auctioned off. He is okay with the \$25,000 from legal. If additional money is needed, it could come from fund balance.

A motion was made by Mr. Temple and seconded by Mr. Raymond to take the City Manager's budget of \$16,389,069, add \$80,000 for one position at the Library and subtract \$100,000 from the culvert program, leaving Public Works with \$345,000.

Mr. McNutt said paying for a person out of fund balance is irresponsible. Mr. Temple said it would be up to Mr. McNutt to find the money.

After some discussion, a motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Raymond to amend the motion to remove \$100,000 from the fund balance for a total of \$1,018,855 with a Revenue total of \$5,836,815.

Ms. Walter said the tax rate would be \$15.04. Mr. Damren said it is a 17-cent increase.

Roll call vote on the amendment: Motion carried 7-2, with Messrs. Bergeron and Koloski voting no.

Mr. Bergeron asked if the Library position is funded for \$80,000, does that mean the Business person would not be hired. Mr. McNutt said if you raise the tax rate and add the \$80,000 to the budget, that could be done.

Mr. Koloski said he couldn't support this; he would rather go with a hybrid version of option 1. He's not interested in raising the tax rate. He has unanswered questions, so will vote no.

Below is the motion including the amendment:

A motion was made by Mr. Temple and seconded by Mr. Raymond to take the City Manager's budget of \$16,389,069, add \$80,000 for one position at the Library, subtract \$100,000 from the culvert program leaving Public Works with \$345,000 as amended. Total \$16,369,069. Offsetting Revenue \$5,836,815.

Mayor Lovett said that will be a 17-cent increase. Ms. Walter said the estimated tax rate is \$15.04

Roll call vote: motion failed 4-5 with Ms. Towle, Mr. Bergeron, Mr. Damren, Mr. Koloski and Mayor Lovett voting no.

Mayor Lovett asked Councilors if they will support any increase in the current tax rate. Councilors voting no: Ms. Towle, Mr. Bergeron, Mr. Damren and Mayor Lovett. Councilors voting yes: Mr. Pope, Mr. Raymond and Mr. Simonds (depending what for). Councilors undecided: Mr. Temple and Mr. Koloski (depends).

Councilors continued discussions.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Towle to approve the City Manager's budget of \$16,389,069 as submitted.

Roll call vote: motion failed 3-6 with Mr. Pope, Mr. Raymond, Mr. Temple, Mr. Koloski Mr. Simonds and Mayor Lovett voting no.

Councilors continued discussions.

A motion was made by Mayor Lovett and seconded by Mr. Damren to approve option #1: Reductions

- \$55,000 from 411 for a total of \$456,031
- \$12,000 from 422 for a total of \$2,541,805
- \$77,000 from Planning & Development for a total of \$775,817
- \$5,000 from 417, General Services, for a total of \$929,394
- Bottom line \$16,240,069

Councilors continued discussions.

A motion was made by Mayor Lovett and seconded by Mr. Damren to amend the motion to include the following additions:

- \$78,860 to 450, Library, for a total of \$420,847
- \$25,000 to 485, Outside Agency, for the bus service for a total of \$25,000
- \$3,000 to Police for a total of \$2,855,948
- Bottom line \$16,346,929

Mr. Simonds clarified that this proposal will eliminate the funding for the Business Development Coordinator. Ms. Taylor said this eliminates the funding, but not the position.

Mr. Temple is disappointed with the \$25,000 and giving up the economic development position. He had previously asked Planning and Development Director Nancy Merrill if her budget supported the City Manager's plan to increase economic development and she said yes.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Raymond to move the question.

Roll call vote to move the question: motion carried 9-0.

Roll call vote on the amendment: motion failed 4-5 with Messrs. Pope, Raymond, Temple, Koloski and Simonds voting no.

Roll call vote to approve option #1-reductions: motion failed 1-8 with all Councilors except Mr. Bergeron voting no.

There was a request to bring back Mr. Temple's motion. Ms. Taylor read Council Rule 33 Reconsideration.

A motion was made by Ms. Towle and seconded by Mr. Raymond to reconsider Mr. Temple's motion.

Roll call vote to reconsider: motion carried 7-2 with Messrs. Bergeron and Koloski voting no.

A motion was made by Ms. Towle and seconded by Mr. Raymond to take the City Manager's proposed budget of \$16,389,069, add \$80,000 for one position at the Library, subtract \$100,000 from the Street expense side for the culvert program leaving Public Works with \$345,000, and not take \$100,000 from fund balance. Total \$16,369,069. Offsetting revenue \$5,836,815.

Ms. Walter said if Council leaves the City Manager's budget as proposed, he will find the \$25,000 for the bus in the budget.

Roll call vote: motion carried 6-3 with Mr. Bergeron, Mr. Koloski and Mayor Lovett voting no.

George Caccavaro said he appreciated the Library position being kept in the budget.

Resolution 2017-45 Rice Reservoir Spillway – Public Hearing

WHEREAS by Resolution 2007-14, the City Council established a City Forest Management Fund (the Fund), pursuant to RSA 34:1-a, for the maintenance, operation and management of city-owned undeveloped land, to be funded by the proceeds from the sale of timber harvested according to the City's Forest Management Plan; and

WHEREAS the City Council found that there is a need for maintenance and improvements to the Rice Reservoir Dam Spillway (the “Spillway”) to protect the integrity of the Dam and the safety of the City's water supply; and

WHEREAS the City Council further finds that the maintenance and improvements to the Spillway is the type of management of City-owned land intended by establishment of the Fund;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED to raise, appropriate and expend the sum of up to \$150,000.00 for maintenance and improvements to the Rice Reservoir Dam Spillway; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager, or his designees, are hereby authorized to withdraw the sum of up to \$150,000.00 from the City Forest Management Fund for the purpose of maintenance and improvements to the Rice Reservoir Dam Spillway (to have no impact on the tax rate), and also to undertake all actions and execute all documents that may be required to implement this resolution.

Mr. Sweet said the they’ve received a bid for \$117,000. There is \$270,000 in the fund. They are requesting to take up to \$150,000 in case there are change orders.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. Damren to adopt Resolution 2017-45 Rice Reservoir Spillway.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Roll call vote: motion carried 9-0.

Resolution 2018-3 To Adopt the 2018 Water Division Budget for the City of Claremont – Public Hearing

WHEREAS in accordance with the Charter of the City of Claremont and the Statutes of the State of New Hampshire, the City Council is required to establish a budget for its appropriations and revenues for its municipal activities; and

WHEREAS in accordance with said Charter, a public hearing was held on June 14, 2017 to provide oral and written comments on said proposed appropriations and revenues; and

WHEREAS the City of Claremont Water and Sewer Divisions are operated as separate entities and by revenues derived from their individual enterprises;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, that it hereby adopts the following for its proposed expenditures and revenues for the Water Division as published.

A motion was made by Mr. Simonds and seconded by Mr. Damren to adopt Resolution 2018-3 To Adopt the 2018 Water Division Budget for the City of Claremont.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Roll call vote: motion carried 9-0.

Resolution 2018-4 To Adopt the 2018 Sewer Division Budget for the City of Claremont – Public Hearing

WHEREAS in accordance with the Charter of the City of Claremont and the Statutes of the State of New Hampshire, the City Council is required to establish a budget for its appropriations and revenues for its municipal activities; and

WHEREAS in accordance with said Charter, a public hearing was held on June 14, 2017 to provide oral and written comments on said proposed appropriations and revenues; and

WHEREAS the City of Claremont Water and Sewer Divisions are operated as separate entities and by revenues derived from their individual enterprises;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, that it hereby adopts the following for its proposed expenditures and revenues for the Sewer Division as published.

A motion was made by Mr. Raymond and seconded by Mr. Simonds to adopt Resolution 2018-4 To Adopt the 2018 Sewer Division Budget for the City of Claremont.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Roll call vote: motion carried 9-0.

Resolution 2018-5 To Adopt the 2018 Downtown Tax Increment Finance District Budget for the City of Claremont – Public Hearing

WHEREAS in accordance with the Charter of the City of Claremont and the Statutes of the State of New Hampshire, the City Council is required to establish a budget for its appropriations and revenues for its municipal activities; and

WHEREAS in accordance with said Charter, a public hearing was held on June 14, 2017 to provide oral and written comments on said proposed appropriations and revenues; and

WHEREAS in accordance with RSA 162-K:12 the City Council must review and approve the operating budget of a tax increment finance district;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, that it hereby adopts the following for its proposed expenditures and revenues for the Downtown Tax Increment Finance District as published.

A motion was made by Mr. Simonds and seconded by Mr. Damren to adopt Resolution 2018-5 To Adopt the 2018 Downtown Tax Increment Finance District Budget for the City of Claremont.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Roll call vote: motion carried 9-0.

OLD BUSINESS

Ordinance 555 Amend Chapter 2, Article V, Merit System – Second Reading – Public Hearing

The purpose of this proposed change is to revise the provision of the Merit Plan related to health insurance.

Enactment of this Ordinance will revise Section 2-401(a) by: 1) eliminating reference to a specific health insurance plan so that the Code does not need to be amended every time the City changes the health insurance plan offered to Merit Plan employees; and 2) clarifying the provision related to employees opting out of the City's health insurance plan.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Mr. Damren to adopt Ordinance 555 Amend Chapter 2, Article V, Merit System.

Mr. Koloski read the explanation of proposed action into the record.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

Resolution 2017-44 Encumbrances – Public Hearing

BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, after public hearing duly noticed, that it hereby adopts the 2017 encumbrances as published.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Raymond to adopt Resolution 2017-44 Encumbrances.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Mr. Temple pointed out that out of the \$1.6 million in encumbrances, \$690,200 is for the Water Enterprise Fund, \$530,000 is for Highway budget for Bowen and Main Streets, which leaves about \$400,000 in encumbrances not in capital improvements.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

None

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Mr. Damren would like to discuss reserves for both water and sewer sometime in July.

Mr. Pope would like an updated list of tax deeded properties. Ms. Taylor said that will come back at the June 28th meeting with the tax deed information.

Mr. Koloski asked about closing off the open “window” areas as you head up the stairs to the Opera House. Ms. Towle said that has been done.

Mayor Lovett reminded Councilors they will do the City Manager’s review at the next meeting and to come prepared with comments/concerns.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None

ADJOURNMENT

At 10:44 p.m., a motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Raymond to adjourn.

Voice vote: motion carried 9-0.

Respectfully Submitted,

Dorée M. Russell
Clerk to the Council